

INTERNAL — RESTRICTED

FM-004

Aged Domain Acquisition

Operations Handbook

STRASSER + LAB

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Classification: Internal

§ Why Aged Domains Matter

Email gateways check domain age. A domain registered yesterday gets a high spam score before the email is even opened. A domain registered 3+ years ago passes the age check silently.

DOMAIN AGE	SPAM SCORE IMPACT	INBOX RATE
0–30 days	Heavy penalty	30–50%
1–6 months	Moderate penalty	50–70%
6–12 months	Light penalty	70–85%
3+ years	No penalty	85–95%
5+ years	Trust bonus	90–98%

§ Best Sources

1. ExpiredDomains.net — Free Search (Start Here)

URL: `https://expireddomains.net`

This is the industry-standard free tool. 500,000+ expired and expiring domains, updated daily.

Filter setup:

TLD:	.com, .net, .org, .cc
Age:	3+ years
Backlinks:	10 minimum
Price:	\$0-\$200
Exclude:	Adult, Gambling, Pharmacy, Casino
Sort by:	Domain Age (oldest first)

How to evaluate a candidate:

1

Copy the domain name

2

Open `https://web.archive.org` — paste the domain

3

Check what the site USED to be. If it was a real business, blog, or local service — good. If it was a spam page or parked domain with ads — skip.

4

Run through `https://mxtoolbox.com/blacklists.aspx` — must show 0/100 blacklists

5

Check USPTO for trademarks: `https://www.uspto.gov/trademarks/search`

2. GoDaddy Auctions — Largest Inventory

URL: `https://auctions.godaddy.com`

65% of all expired domain sales happen here.

Filter for bargains:

Type:	Closeout (fixed price, no bidding)
Price:	Under \$50
Age:	2+ years
TLD:	.com, .net, .cc

Closeout domains are \$12 + registration fee. They're domains nobody bid on during the auction phase. Most are garbage but 5–10% are hidden gems — small businesses that shut down, personal blogs that were abandoned, local services that went out of business. These have clean history at a bargain price.

3. NotRenewing.com — Flat \$99

URL: <https://notrenewing.com>

Launched March 2026. Every domain is \$99 fixed price. Minimum 24 months old, expiring within 12 months. Sellers list domains they plan to let expire anyway. Good for finding domains with 3–5 years of clean history at a predictable price.

4. NameJet / SnapNames — Backordering

URL: <https://namejet.com> | <https://snapnames.com>

Place a backorder on an expiring domain. If you're the only bidder, you get it at the reserve price (\$69). If multiple bidders, it goes to a 3-day private auction. Best for targeting domains you've already vetted on ExpiredDomains.net.

§ Step-by-Step Acquisition

Step 1: Hunt (5 minutes)

6

Open ExpiredDomains.net

7

Apply filters: `.com` / `.net` / `.cc` , age 3+, backlinks 10+, price under \$200

8

Open 20 candidates in tabs

Step 2: Vet (2 minutes per domain)

9

Web Archive check — was it a real site?

10

Blacklist check — is it clean?

11

Trademark check — is it safe to use?

12

Backlink check — are links from real sites or spam farms?

Step 3: Buy

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GoDaddy Closeout: click “Buy Now” → checkout → domain in your account in minutes

14

NotRenewing: click “Buy” → pay \$99 → domain transferred within 24 hours

15

NameJet backorder: place bid → wait for domain to drop → if won, domain in account in 24 hours

Step 4: Transfer to Cloudflare

16

After purchase, unlock the domain at your registrar

17

Get the transfer authorization code

18

Cloudflare Dashboard → Add Site → Transfer Domain

19

Enter the code → pay 1 year renewal → domain lives on Cloudflare

20

Set up DNS + Worker (our standard deployment)

§ Red Flags – Do NOT Buy

Warning: These are hard stops. A single red flag means reject the domain — no exceptions.

- ✗ **Parked with ads** — the domain was never a real site, just a landing page with ads. No backlink value, likely flagged.
- ✗ **Pharmacy/casino/adult history** — even if clean now, these niches trigger spam filters permanently.
- ✗ **Trademarked name** — using “microsoft-support.cc” gets you sued and your domain seized.
- ✗ **Spam score above 5%** — Moz Spam Score or similar. Check before buying.
- ✗ **Dropped multiple times** — WHOIS shows repeated creation dates. The domain was repeatedly abandoned.
- ✗ **Chinese/Japanese characters in backlinks** — common sign of a spam network.

§ Quick Reference

<code>ExpiredDomains.net</code>	– Free domain hunting (start here)
<code>GoDaddy Auctions</code>	– Closeout bargains (\$12+)
<code>NotRenewing.com</code>	– Flat \$99 aged domains
<code>NameJet</code>	– Backordering (pay only if you win)
<code>web.archive.org</code>	– Check what a domain used to be
<code>mxtoolbox.com</code>	– Blacklist check
<code>uspto.gov</code>	– Trademark search

§ **Budget**

\$50–\$150 gets you a solid aged domain. Here’s the breakdown for the most common path — grabbing a GoDaddy closeout and transferring to Cloudflare:

STAGE	COST
GoDaddy Closeout purchase	\$12–\$50
Transfer to Cloudflare	\$8–\$10 (1 year renewal)
Total	\$20–\$60

For \$150 you can get a 5+ year aged `.com` with clean history and 20+ backlinks. Worth every dollar for the inbox rate improvement.